

These metrics can include attacks to important operating system files, triggered events, clogging e-mail servers, deleting or modifying files, releasing confidential information, performance degradation, compromising security settings, and the ease with which the damage may be fixed.

Dialler

Software that dials a phone number. Some dialers connect to local Internet Service Providers and are beneficial as configured. Others connect to toll numbers without user awareness or permission.

Direct Action Virus

A virus that attempts to locate and infect one or more targets when it is run and then exits, is called a direct action virus. In single-tasking operating systems such as DOS, direct action viruses usually only infect a small number of targets during each run, as the 'find then infect' process slows the normal execution of the infected host from which the virus is running and significant slowing of a machine is likely to warn its user of the presence of something 'untoward'.

DOS

Disk Operating System-most famously, MS DOS and IBM DOS, but also DR DOS and others.

Downloader

A downloader is a program that automatically downloads and runs and/or installs other software without the user's knowledge or permission.

Dropper, Injector

A program that installs a virus, but is not, itself, infected is known as a dropper. These are not very common and most are used to install boot viruses.

Disinfection

Most anti-virus software carries out disinfection after reporting the presence of a virus. During disinfection, the virus may be removed and, whenever possible, any affected data is recovered.